

Unit description

The unit content is divided into **two** sections, with each section outlining the specific knowledge and understanding required by the student.

The first section will develop the student's knowledge and understanding of what constitutes a healthy and active lifestyle. Students will investigate how the body responds and adapts to exercise, the components of physical and skill fitness and different methods of fitness training. The rationale behind carrying out fitness assessments and the protocols associated with recognised fitness tests will also be considered.

The second section encourages the student to develop their knowledge and understanding of how competitive sport has developed over time. They will learn how a lifelong involvement in sport is encouraged.

Assessment information

The assessment of this unit is through a 1 hour and 30 minute examination paper which is set and marked by Pearson.

The paper will be a question-and-answer booklet and all questions in the paper are compulsory. The paper will consist of short-answer and extended-writing type questions.

The total marks for the paper are 90.

What students need to learn

1.1 Healthy and Active Lifestyles

The development of active leisure and recreation

Requirements for participation

Students should understand the following concepts and be able to apply them to practical examples:

- fitness
- ability
- resources
- time

Concepts of recreation and active leisure

- Philosophy of mass participation, including its origins and the principles behind it
- Sport for all, including its history and the impact of related policies

Contemporary concerns

Students should understand the following contemporary concerns, including recognising their causes, related implications on health and how active and healthy lifestyles can reduce potential negative effects:

- obesity, coronary heart disease, diabetes, high blood pressure, high cholesterol, metabolic syndrome, sedentary lifestyles, activity patterns, ageing population, access, stress, negative lifestyle choices, including smoking, drinking and drugs.

Healthy lifestyle

Health, fitness and exercise

Students should understand the differences and links between health, fitness and exercise:

- physical (energy expenditure)
- psychological

Positive health benefits:

- reduction in body fat
- increased resting metabolic rate and/or increased proportion of muscle mass
- reduced rates of mortality, coronary heart disease (CHD), obesity, reduced risk of osteoporosis, and help type II diabetes management

Nutrition and weight management

Energy intake, food groups, hydration, balanced diet, food pyramid, cholesterol, dietary requirements for exercise

Current trends in health

Comparative cultures, eg USA, Finland, Japan

Balanced lifestyle

- Energy balance (energy intake versus energy expenditure)
- Work-life balance, including dealing with stress

Effects of ageing

Students should understand the point of physical maturation, how and why this differs between sports, and the effects of ageing there after, including:

- decline in physical capability (cardiovascular fitness, muscular strength, lung function, resting metabolic rate, osteoporosis, flexibility)

Effects of exercise

Responses and adaptations of the body systems

Students should understand why body systems respond and adapt as they do, and the differences between structural and functional responses and adaptations:

Muscular-skeletal system

- Responses (fibre recruitment, force production, metabolism)
- Adaptations (increase fibre size, increase force production, increase metabolic energy supply)

Cardiovascular system

- Responses (increase stroke volume, heart rate, cardiac output, redistribution of blood flow to working muscle)
- Adaptations (increase in size of heart, stroke volume, cardiac output and number of capillaries)

Respiratory system

- Responses (increased rate and depth of breathing, increased gas exchange)
- Adaptations (improvements in respiratory muscle performance)

Neuro-muscular system

- Responses (increased number of muscle fibres recruited, increase in rate of fibre recruitment)
- Adaptations (improved co-ordination, increases in force production and rate of force production, increase in speed)